

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

Lead Your AI Squad: why it works, every key, what-ifs, and the standards map.



WHY THIS LESSON

It stands alone: every skill it uses is re-taught on the page. The idea: **an AI agent does a whole job, step by step, on its own — and if your card leaves something out, the agent usually fills the gap with a guess and keeps going.** Some tools stop and ask instead; name both. A good AI job runs **human → AI → human**, so the human job moves from doing the work to leading it: you write the quest card, the AI does the middle, you check the loot before it ships. On paper, the guess comes from you: one whispered fake fact per team, so every review has something real to catch. For the adults in the room: a quest card is a brief, and this loop is delegation. Students may one day run real projects and real AI tools this way. Nobody can promise what those tools will look like.

EXEMPLAR QUEST CARDS (BOTH QUESTS; GAME NIGHT IS THE BOARD MODEL)

GOAL: get 6th graders to actually show up to Game Night. **WHAT WE KNOW:** Friday, gym, 6–8 pm; we have board games and two TVs. **RULES OF THE RUN:** school-appropriate, big readable title, 40 words max. **DONE LOOKS LIKE:** one flyer draft, ready to photocopy.

Class magazine, issue #1 (the other quest): **GOAL:** get every 6th-grade homeroom to read issue #1. **WHAT WE KNOW:** one class period a week for three weeks; 24 writers; the library printer is black and white. **RULES OF THE RUN:** 8 pages, school-appropriate, nobody is named without being asked first. **DONE LOOKS LIKE:** a page-by-page plan with a writer's name on every page.

How to score any quest card (Step 2 and Exit #1): hand it to the most literal reader in the room. If they can twist it, or have to guess, a part is missing or vague. **Proficient** = all four parts, specific enough that a stranger could do it tomorrow. **Developing** = parts present but vague ("make it good," "soon"). **Beginning** = a wish, not a quest card ("help me with math").

SUPPORT & ELL: QUEST CARD SENTENCE STARTERS

GOAL: "When this quest is done, ____ will happen." · **WHAT WE KNOW:** "This is for _____. The team already has _____."

RULES OF THE RUN: "It must _____. It must NOT _____. Due _____." · **DONE LOOKS LIKE:** "Hand back a _____ (flyer / list / plan / paragraph)."

ELL: draft in their strongest language first, then translate. The four labels double as language frames.

✓ THANK YOU & TERMS OF USE

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EXEMPLAR SQUAD OUTPUT (STEP 3 — SANA'S SQUAD, GAME NIGHT CARD)

ROLE	WHAT GOOD OUTPUT LOOKS LIKE
Planner (DeShawn)	1. Pick the games and the TV setup (5 min). 2. Write the flyer title and the when/where line (5 min). 3. ★ Add a 40-word pitch (10 min). 4. Count the words, check every rule (3 min). 5. NOT ON THE CARD: who photocopies it, and how many? <i>Score: numbered, timed, one star, and a flag instead of a guess. Flags are gold: they're the next card's fixes. The time guesses don't have to be right; making them is what scores.</i>
Scout (Lucia)	Friday ✓ (on the card) · gym ✓ (on the card) · 6–8 pm ✓ (on the card) · [planted] prizes for the winners ✓ (on the card) · both TVs actually work? ? (ask whoever runs the gym) · how many 6th graders there are ? (the front office). Questions (4–8 min): "Do both TVs work, and can we use them Friday night?" (gym) · "How many 6th graders are there this year?" (front office). <i>Score: every ✓ has a "how we know"; every ? has a "where to check." A fact with neither is a guess wearing a costume. Class magazine, issue #1: three weeks ✓ · 24 writers ✓ (both on the card) · does the library printer do color? ? (ask the librarian) · how many homerooms need a copy ? (the front office).</i>
Critic (Sana)	Care about: which games, and whether friends are going. Would hate: a flyer that looks like homework. Upgrades: (1) Put the TVs and the games in the title — 6th graders come for the games, not the date. (2) Cut the 40 words to 25; nobody reads a wall of text on a wall. (3) Add one line for parents: pick-up is at 8. <i>Score: each upgrade names the exact change and ties it to the people on the card. "Make it better" counts for nothing.</i>

FILLED CHECK ROW + NOTE (STEP 4 — LUCIA REVIEWING DESHAWN'S PLAN)

CHECK	EVIDENCE	VERDICT
ACCURACY	"No made-up facts. Step 5 flags a gap instead of guessing."	SHIP IT
TASTE	"Step 3, 'Add a 40-word pitch': for who? Could be anybody."	RUN IT BACK
DONE-NESS	"Numbered, timed, one star, one NOT ON THE CARD flag."	SHIP IT

KEEP: "Steps 1–4 are timed, and step 5 flags a gap instead of guessing." **FIX:** "Make step 3 'a 40-word pitch for 6th graders.' The card says who it's for." *Score: a line in every row, one box per row, and a FIX that names the change plus why. "Good job, be more specific" is a RUN IT BACK on the leader. Card or party member?* The GOAL names 6th graders, so this one goes to DeShawn, not the card.

THE CURSED AMULET (SANA REVIEWING LUCIA'S FACTS, ACCURACY ROW)

LEADER	EVIDENCE	VERDICT
Caught	"Prizes for the winners ✓' — the card never says prizes." FIX: "Cross out prizes or change it to ?. Ask whoever runs Game Night."	RUN IT BACK
Missed	"Every fact has a ✓ or a ?."	SHIP IT

Score: a catch is Proficient on ACCURACY. A miss costs nothing; it's a trap by design. That leader checked that the marks were there, not that they were true. Say so in the reveal: a ✓ is a claim, not proof. Rotation: Lucia checks DeShawn, Sana checks Lucia, DeShawn checks Sana. Read-back: Scout, Critic, Planner.

✓ ANSWER KEY — EXIT TICKET (WORKSHEET P.3)

ITEM	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
#1 — quest card for a real task (<i>Objective 1</i>)	Exemplar (a study plan): GOAL: pass Friday's fractions quiz with at least a B. WHAT WE KNOW: 7th grade math; I have the review sheet and 30 minutes a night, Monday to Thursday. RULES OF THE RUN: only fractions with different denominators, no calculator, done by Thursday night. DONE LOOKS LIKE: a four-night plan, 5 practice problems a night, answers on a separate line. Score with the quest-card scale on p.1.
#2 — which role should start first, and why (<i>Objective 2</i>)	Any role earns credit if the reason fits the task: <i>scout</i> first for a fact-heavy flyer ("I need the real dates before anyone plans"); <i>planner</i> first for a schedule ("the steps ARE the job"); <i>critic</i> first when the audience is picky ("my little brother won't follow a boring chore list"). The reason is what scores; a role with no reason is Developing.
#3 — the check an AI's work would most likely fail (<i>Objective 3</i>)	Any check with something real to look for: "ACCURACY — the quiz date and which chapter"; "TASTE — is it written for a 12-year-old or for a teacher?"; "DONE-NESS — did it give all four nights, or stop at two?" Proficient names the check AND the specific thing to look for; a check alone is Developing.

WHEN IT GOES SIDeways

The class doesn't divide by 3 → a team of 4 runs two critics in a square, same pass-left rule (both read the plan; they'll disagree, which is great). A team of 2 drops the critic; the leader does the taste check too.

A leader turns harsh → KEEP before FIX, and the leader reads the note aloud to their party member.

A team finishes early → rewrite the quest card so tight the critic can't land a note — or design a fourth squad role and its one-line job.

A card is hopelessly vague and the squad stalls → don't rescue it. "It's not on the card" is the only mid-round answer; in Leader review the RUN IT BACK lands on the card, not the party member. That public, fixable failure is the lesson. (With devices: the projected AI invents a fact — best case. "Which missing rule let it do that?" Add it, run it again.)

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.5.c** — Students break problems into component parts, extract key information, and develop descriptive models to understand complex systems or facilitate problem-solving. *Taught: the Party Leader's Loop instruction (a project broken into four card parts and three roles). Assessed: the Step 2 quest card and Exit Ticket #1, scored with the quest-card scale on p.1.*
- **ISTE 1.7.c** — Students contribute constructively to project teams, assuming various roles and responsibilities to work effectively toward a common goal. *Taught: Run the Quest (every student works one role, then leads one review). Assessed: the Step 3 role output (scored against the exemplar squad output, p.2), the Step 4 CHECK rubric and keep-and-fix note, and Exit Ticket #2.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.4** — Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. (Grade-specific expectations for writing types are defined in standards 1-3 above.) *Taught: quest-card modeling in direct instruction (goal, audience, rules, output). Assessed: Exit Ticket #1 — a four-part quest card written for a real task and audience, scored Proficient / Developing / Beginning.*